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CIS 4374

Homework 1

The Initial Kickoff for Project Documentation (Version 1.0)

Vision And Scope:

Project Acquisition- Our company \$oftware Corp. Wants to branch out into different avenues of software/app development that can help improve another aspect of people's needs in our modern world. The route we identified that best fits this project campaign is to improve how parking in urban areas/cities are and manage them using a digital platform that helps provide parking information in these areas in real-time. This is a problem we want to solve with our app and make it a smart parking platform that can be universal across the nation and make it easier for users to have at their disposal, for now we plan to launch in the Houston area. There is parking systems that are in place already but often tend to have proprietary bottlenecks that lack efficient tools for monitoring parking occupancy and managing parking reservations as well as different payment systems that make frustrating for parking users. We aim to improve the parking experience for users and operators of parking areas by having an efficient system that benefits all parties involved.

Vision Statement- \$oftware Corps new smart parking platform promises a convenient method for users to locate, reserve, and pay for parking spaces on our app or website which in turn will reduce the time that is spent looking for parking and further improve parking facility utilization in urban/city areas. It will also be convenient for parking operators overseeing the parking areas/garages user park their vehicles by using the smart parking platform system to keep payments, vehicles parked and spaces available/unavailable logged.

Project Scope, this project will include the following:

- User account registration and login
- Real-time parking availability
- Parking space search

- Parking reservations
- Navigation assistance
- Digital payment processing
- Alerts and notifications
- Occupancy reporting and analytics
- Administrative dashboard
- Support line for user/manager
- AI helper tool

We will not be focusing on this:

- Maintenance services for vehicles
- Physical construction of parking garages (we are a digital service, if parking garages want to use our services we will have a contracts area to be contacted via website)

Competitive analysis research:

This is a competitive market, there is an abundance of many parking services and management systems in place. Here is some competitors that already have prominence in this market.

ParkMobile- This is the most popular app for parking services that is widely used where users can access app or website and have real-time parking sessions. I'd say there's little to no errors for this app.

Spot Hero- This is another popular app for parking services that specializes in advanced reservations with a large network of parking garages in big city's and also shows price comparisons of each garage. Availability varies by city though so not available in every city.

PayByPhone- This parking app is similar to the ones mentioned prior, it works similar to ParkMobile where a user can find parking using their app or website and have real time parking sessions, but it's not available in every state and you have to manually type in vehicle info and code.

What can Software Corp do to differentiate amongst competitors:

- Use AI-based parking recommendations like an assistant within the app or website to help user
- Have dynamic pricing suggestions to show which place to park has the best pricing
- Real-time occupancy tracking that you see in modern parking garages but within the app or website
- Have a unified website and mobile experience where users can navigate easily
- Have a predictive availability forecasting for available parking, especially for events like concerts or sports games

Initial Stakeholders List:

- Drivers and vehicle owners
 - ^Interested in finding parking in a quick and convenient manner
- Parking facility operators
 - ^Interested in increasing utilization of their parking facilities
- City transportation departments
 - ^Interested in reducing congestion
- System administrators
 - ^Interested in the maintenance of the system
- Finance and billing personnel
 - ^Interested in the processing of the payment
- Mobile application users
 - ^Interested in a convenient app form factor that makes finding and paying for parking easier
- Third-party payment providers
 - ^Interested in providing different methods of payment to users while getting monetary gain from service

Initial Use Cases:

Use case 1: Downloading the app or searching thru web browser

The Actor: User/Driver

The Goal: finding the application or website

Structure of flow:

1. Enter the name of the application that Software Corp will use (sometimes can be found by entering developer name too) on Appstore or web browser.
2. Once found, download to phone or enter site
3. You are now on the platform

Use case 2: Registering for an account

The actor: User/Driver

The Goal: Creating an account for parking app

Structure of flow:

1. As user enter your information into platform
2. The platform's system will proceed to validate information inputted
3. The user's account is created

Use case 3: Finding parking

The Actor: User/Driver

The Goal: Find available parking at desired location

Structure of flow:

1. The user/driver enters desired destination
2. The platform's system will then display nearby parking garages
3. User/driver views availability in parking garages

Use case 4: Reserving the parking spot

The Actor: User/Driver

The Goal: User/Driver will reserve their spot on app

Use Case 5: Making the payment

The Actor: User/Driver

The Goal: The user/driver will make the payment for however long they are parking for on the app

Use Case 6: Using the apps AI assistant

The Actor: User/Driver

The Goal: Being able to find and use AI assistant on the app

SRS Functional/Non-Functional Requirements

Functional requirements:

- We want to allow users to successfully register and log in securely
- The system will be able to display parking availability in real-time
- The system has access to data reports
- The system allows reservation for parking ahead of time
- The system must be able to process any form of online payments via app/website

Non-Functional Requirements:

- The system must support up to 20,000 concurrent users
- The system has to provide 99.99% uptime

- The system must update any and all inventory values in 1 second
- The safety firewall security must block out any unknown sources of payment

References:

Parkmobile parking app: Find & Pay For Parking: On-Street & Reservation. ParkMobile. (n.d.).
<https://parkmobile.io/>

Get everywhere easier: Reserve parking and save. SpotHero. (n.d.-a). <https://spothero.com/>

Simplifying your journey. PayByPhone. (n.d.). <https://www.paybyphone.com/>

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